

6 MONTH STUDY GUIDE

BY CONFIDENT ENGLISH WITH KIRSTY

MONTH 1
BUILD STRONG BASIC SENTENCES

Month 1 Focus:

- Grammar tenses
  - Simple Present
  - Simple Past
  - Simple Future
- Sentence types
  - Statements
  - Questions
  - Negatives
- Vocabulary
  - Useful regular English verbs

Daily Study Routine

Follow this routine every day (or as much as possible!)

Revise verbs and structures – 10 minutes

- Focus on a few verbs from the lists in this document each day
- Sentence structures - write your own phrases + use the verbs

Listening practice – 5 minutes

Watch one short, clear English video:

- If you have a higher intermediate level : BBC News on youtube @BBCNews
- If you have a lower intermediate level : BBC Newsround on youtube @BBCNewsroundOfficial

Speaking practice – 10 minutes

- Repeat full sentences out loud from the video you watch every day
- Pause the video when needed
- Use subtitles or slow the speed if needed

MONTH 1

Below is a rapid summary of basic sentence structure. This is not a detailed grammar lesson - just the simple patterns you need, to build correct sentences.

A. Statements
Statements give information or describe facts.

Structure (basic): Subject + verb (+ object)
Examples:
- I work every day.
- She likes coffee.
- They went home early.

Use statements to:
- Describe your life
- Talk about the past
- Explain plans

B. Questions
Questions are used to ask for information.

Structure (basic): Auxiliary verb or 'be'/modal verb + subject + main verb
Examples:
- Do you work every day?
- Did she call you?
- Are they going to travel next month?

Note: When we say:
"Auxiliary verb or be / modal verb + subject + main verb", it means:
- Start the question with either:
    a. An auxiliary verb (do, did, have, etc.)
    b. The verb "to be" (am, is, are, was, were)
    c. A modal verb (can, will, should, must, etc.)

Then you add:
- The subject (who or what the question is about)
- The main verb (the action)

MONTH 1

Yes/No Questions vs 'WH'- Questions

Yes/No Questions

These questions can be answered with yes or no.

Structure:
Auxiliary verb or be / modal verb + subject + main verb
Examples:

- Do you work every day?
- Did she call you?
- Are they going to travel next month?
- Can you help me?

WH- Questions

These questions ask for specific information.
They start with a question word (what, where, when, why, who, how).

Structure:
Question word + auxiliary verb or 'be' / modal verb + subject + main verb
Examples:

- Where do you work?
- Why did she call you?
- When are they going to travel?
- How can I help you?

Important note:
When who is the subject, the structure changes slightly.
Example:

- Who called you?
- (not Who did call you?)

C. Negatives
Negatives say that something is not true.

Structure (basic): Subject + auxiliary verb + not + main verb
Examples:

- I do not work on Sundays.
- She didn't call me. (not → n't)
- They aren't going to travel this month.

MONTH 1

Verb	Simple Present	Simple Past	Simple Future
Use	use/uses	used	will use
Find	find/finds	found	will find
Give	give/gives	gave	will give
Tell	tell/tells	told	will tell
Work	work/works	worked	will work
Call	call/calls	called	will call
Try	try/tries	tried	will try
Ask	ask/asks	asked	will ask
Need	need/needs	needed	will need
Feel	feel/feels	felt	will feel
Become	become/becomes	became	will become
Leave	leave/leaves	left	will leave
Put	put/puts	put	will put

MONTH 1

Verb	Simple Present	Simple Past	Simple Future
Mean	mean/means	meant	will mean
Keep	keep/keeps	kept	will keep
Let	let/lets	let	will let
Begin	begin/begins	began	will begin
Seem	seem/seems	seemed	will seem
Help	help/helps	helped	will help
Talk	talk/talks	talked	will talk
Turn	turn/turns	turned	will turn
Start	start/starts	started	will start
Show	show/shows	showed	will show
Hear	hear/hears	heard	will hear
Play	play/plays	played	will play

MONTH 1

Verb	Simple Present	Simple Past	Simple Future
Run	run/runs	ran	will run
Move	move/moves	moved	will move
Live	live/lives	lived	will live
Believe	believe/believes	believed	will believe
Bring	bring/brings	brought	will bring
Happen	happen/happens	happened	will happen
Write	write/writes	wrote	will write
Provide	provide/provides	provided	will provide
Sit	sit/sits	sat	will sit
Stand	stand/stands	stood	will stand
Lose	lose/loses	lost	will lose
Pay	pay/pays	paid	will pay

MONTH 2
UNDERSTAND REAL SPOKEN ENGLISH

Month 2 Focus:

- Understand fast spoken English
- Recognise linking sounds
- Practise reductions and weak forms (to, of, for, a)
- Copy natural rhythm and pronunciation from real speakers

Daily Study Routine

Every day:

Listening: 10–15 minutes

- Watch English videos with different accents
- Suggested resource: TED Talks on YouTube @TED
- Focus on hearing rhythm, reductions, and weak forms

Repeating & copying (shadowing): 10–15 minutes

- Repeat phrases exactly as native speakers say them
- Focus on linking sounds, reductions, and rhythm (see the rules below ⬇️)
- Pause the video if needed, to imitate natural speech

Video: LISTEN TO REDUCTIONS - understand fast English

Watch this video I made to hear reductions, weak forms, and linking, in real fast English: https://youtu.be/DlbRzALoejI

Optional : Get Weekly Practice if you join Kirsty's Accelerator or VIP membership (level 2 and 3): https://stan.store/ConfidentEnglishwithKirsty

- 30-minute weekly **webinar**
- **Focus: understanding and using FAST ENGLISH**

MONTH 2

Rules for Reductions, Contractions, Weak Forms, and Linking Sounds

These rules will help you understand and reproduce fast, natural English.

A. Reductions and Contractions (Shortened Forms)

Reductions & Contractions make English faster and smoother. They usually combine words.

Common reductions and contractions:

I am - **I'm** - I'm going to study.
He is - **He's** - He's coming tomorrow.
I will - **I'll** - I'll call you later.
Going to - **gonna** - I'm gonna talk about sport. (do not use in written English)
Want to - **wanna** - I wanna eat now .(do not use in written English)
Have to - **hafta** - I hafta finish this. (do not use in written English)
Let us - **let's** - Let's go to the park.
Do you like it - D'you like it? (do not use in written English)

Tip: Reductions and contractions are very common in spoken English. To sound natural you don't always pronounce every word fully; try to imitate natural rhythm.

B. Weak Forms

Weak forms are unstressed versions of common words, pronounced quickly in normal speech. They help English sound smooth and connected.

Important weak forms:

to /tə/ - I'm going to /tə/ study.
of /əv/ - A cup of /əv/ tea.
for /fə/ - This is for /fə/ you.
a /ə/ - I need a /ə/ pen.
and /ən/ - Bread and /ən/ butter.
the /ðə/ or /ði/ - The /ðə/ book is here.

Tip: Listen for weak forms; they often sound like "uh" or "ə", not the full dictionary pronunciation.

Watch this video I made to hear weak forms (the Schwa), in real fast English:
https://youtu.be/DIbRzALoejI

MONTH 2

C. Linking Sounds (How Words Join Together)

In natural spoken English, words do not stay separate. They link together, Linking makes English sound smooth, fast, and natural.

1. Consonant + Vowel Linking

When a word ends with a consonant sound and the next word starts with a vowel sound, the sounds join.

Examples:
pick it → pick_it
take it → take_it
find out → find_out
make a → make_a

You pronounce it like one long word, not two separate words.
Tip: If you stop between the words, your English sounds slow and unnatural. Try to connect them smoothly.

2. Vowel + Vowel Linking (Using a Small /w/ or /j/ Sound)

When one word ends in a vowel sound and the next word starts with a vowel sound, English adds a small linking sound.

This is not a real word — just a sound to help pronunciation.

Examples:
/w/ sound (after "oo" or "oh" sounds):
go on → gowon
do it → dowit
how are → howware

/j/ sound (after "ee" or "ai" sounds):
I am → Iyam
she is → sheyis
they are → theyyare

Tip: Native speakers do this automatically.
Don't think too much - let the sounds flow together.
It may feel difficult at first, but the more you notice these sounds in videos, the easier it becomes.

MONTH 2

3. Same Sound Linking

When one word ends and the next word starts with the same consonant sound, you pronounce it once, longer.

Examples:
big girl → bigirl
good day → gooday
black cat → blackat

Tip: Hold the sound slightly longer, but don't say it twice.

D. Elision (When Sounds Disappear)

Elision happens when a sound disappears in fast, natural English.
Native speakers often remove sounds, especially when words are close together.
This makes English easier and faster to say.

1. Elision of /t/ and /d/ Sounds

The most common elision happens with /t/ and /d/ sounds.
When /t/ or /d/ is between two consonant sounds, it is often not pronounced.

Examples:
next please → nex please
first prize → firs prize
friends → frens
hand bag → han bag

Tip: The sound is still "there" in spelling, but not in speech.

Watch this video I made to hear elision, in real fast English:
https://youtu.be/DIbRzALoejI

MONTH 2

2. Elision in Consonant Clusters

English does not like too many consonants together.
When words become difficult to pronounce, a sound is often removed (not always!).

Examples:
grandma → gran-ma
asked → askt / askt → ast
sandwich → san-wich

Tip: Don't try to pronounce every letter. Focus on what you hear.

3. Elision Across Word Boundaries

Sounds can disappear between words, not just inside words.

Examples:
next week → nex week
next day → nex day
last night → las night

Note: This is normal spoken English, not lazy English.

MONTH 3

Speak Without Panicking

Month 3 Focus:

Month 3 focuses on speaking without panicking.

You will practise:

- Answering common questions
- Talking about: Daily life, The past, Future plans
- Speaking without stopping

This month is about confidence and flow.

Daily Practice Routine:

Listening – 5–10 minutes

Watch interview-style videos
Suggested channel: @WIRED (YouTube)

Focus on:

- How questions are asked
- How answers start and continue naturally

Answering Questions Out Loud – 10 minutes

Use the question list below to:

- Answer out loud
- Do not write answers
- Do not stop to correct yourself

Example questions:

- What did you do today?
- Describe a summer memory from your childhood.

MONTH 3

Timed Speaking – 5–10 minutes

Use the 4-3-2 speaking method

Speak continuously without stopping on a topic of your choice

Speaking Questions & Topics :

Use these questions for daily speaking practice.

Daily Life

- What did you do today?
- What is a normal day like for you?
- What do you usually do in the morning?
- What do you usually do in the evening?
- What do you do when you have free time?
- What is something you do every week?

Past Experiences

- What did you do yesterday?
- What did you do last weekend?
- Describe a summer memory from your childhood.
- Talk about a day you remember clearly.
- Describe a place you visited in the past.
- Talk about a time you felt happy or proud.

Future Plans

- What are you going to do this weekend?
- What are your plans for next week?
- What are you going to do this year?
- What would you like to do in the future?
- What are you going to do to improve your English?
- Where would you like to travel one day?

Personal Information

- Describe yourself.
- Talk about your family.
- Talk about where you live.
- Describe your job or studies.

Opinions & Preferences

- What do you like doing in your free time?
- What kind of music do you like?
- Do you prefer studying alone or with other people?
- What is your favourite place to relax?
- What do you enjoy about learning English?

Simple Descriptions

- Describe your hometown.
- Describe a person you know well.
- Describe a place you like.
- Describe a typical day in your life.

.

MONTH 4

VOCABULARY, PRONUNCIATION & CLARITY

Month 4 Focus:

Month 4 is about sounding clearer and more natural
You will focus on:

- Learning new vocabulary from your daily listening routine
- Core phrasal verbs

Vocabulary for:

- Daily life
- Work & study
- Health & well-being

A list of phrasal verbs is included below ⬇️

Daily Practice Routine:

Vocabulary Revision & Sentence Creation – 5 minutes

- Revise vocabulary from the lists in this PDF (focus on phrasal verbs)
- Create your own sentences
- Say new words out loud
- Spell-check your sentences online if you wish

Input Listening – 10 minutes

Watch or listen to a video or podcast
Suggested source: National Geographic @NatGeo

Notice:

- New words and phrases
- How words are pronounced clearly
- How ideas are explained simply

MONTH 4

Output Speaking – 10 minutes

- Describe what you watched or listened to in your daily video
- Speak as if telling a friend

Focus on:

- Clear pronunciation
- Using phrasal verbs
- Explaining ideas clearly

Core Phrasal Verbs:

These phrasal verbs are high-frequency and useful in everyday speaking

.

Daily Life

wake up
get up
go out
stay in
come back
head out
hang out
sit down
stand up
turn on
turn off
pick up

Work & Study

finish up
look for
find out
work on
deal with
sort out
set up
take on
catch up (on)
carry on
put off

MONTH 4

Health & Routine
slow down
cut down (on)
get over
warm up
cool down
look after
give up
feel run down
pass out
come down with
bounce back

Try to use them when describing what you watched or listened to

Tip:

📌 How to Use the Vocabulary Lists in this document:

- Don’t try to learn everything at once
- Look up words, verbs or phrasal verbs you don’t know
- Choose a small number each day
- Create your own sentences
- Say them out loud
- Try to use them when describing what you watched or listened to

MONTH 5

FLUENCY & AUTOMATIC SPEAKING

Month 5 Focus:

Month 5 is about speed and flow.
The goal is to speak automatically, without stopping to think or translate in your head.

This month you focus on:

- Ready-made ‘speaking chunks’
- Vocabulary for linking ideas naturally
- Speaking without pausing or planning
- The full list of ‘speaking chunks’ and linking words is below ⬇️.

Daily Practice Routine:

Listening to Real Conversations – 5–10 minutes

Listen to real spoken English
Suggested source: Big Think channel @BigThink (YouTube)

Use:

- Subtitles if needed
- Slower playback speed if needed (this is possible on Youtube)

Focus on:

- Intonation
- How speakers link ideas

Shadowing Full Sentences – 15 minutes

Shadow full sentences from what you hear in your daily listening

Copy:

- Reductions
- Intonation
- Rhythm
- Do not pause too much. Stay close to the speaker’s speed if possible.

MONTH 5

Speaking Without Stopping – 5 minutes

Speak out loud while doing daily activities

Describe:

- What you are doing
- What you are thinking (“*In my opinion, people spend too much time on their phones…*”)
- What is happening around you

Example:

“I’m making coffee now. I’m waiting for the water to boil. I’m going to sit down and start work. I can see a bird in the garden. I feel like I need a break before I go back to my desk. Also, I’m hungry.”

Ready-Made Speaking Chunks (Month 5):

Use these chunks to start speaking quickly without planning sentences:

Starting What You are Saying

I think that it’s important to…
I feel like it’s not always easy to…
The main thing is…
What I want to say is…
One thing I’ve noticed is…

Giving Examples

For instance when we…
Like I said before there are…
A good example of this is…

Adding Information

On top of that, did you see…
Another thing is…
As well as that…

Explaining or Clarifying

What I mean is, it looks like…
In other words, I would like to…
I mean to say that…

Ending or Changing Direction

In the end, it all worked out fine…
At the same time, I don’t think…
That’s why we/I…

Practise these chunks as complete phrases, not individual words.

MONTH 5

Linking Words & Phrases

These words help you connect ideas smoothly and speak with better flow.

Sequencing Ideas
- first
- then
- after that
- finally

Cause & Result
- because
- so
- that's why
- as a result

Contrast
- but
- however
- on the other hand
- at the same time

Giving Opinions
- I think
- I believe
- in my opinion
- from my point of view

2 videos to watch:
- Linking words for flow: https://youtu.be/jl6-iK3MgK8
- Linking words for fluency: https://youtu.be/ybSt8kVBi5I

📌 **How to Use Chunks & Linking Words**
- Don't memorize long lists - choose a small number each day
- Write full sentences using each chunk or linking word
- Important: Say your sentences out loud after writing them!

Use them actively:
- When speaking without stopping
- When describing your daily activities

MONTH 6

REAL CONFIDENCE & ADVANCED CONTROL

Month 6 Focus:

Month 6 is about using English in real conversations.
The focus is on:

- Explaining ideas clearly
- Organising thoughts and opinions
- Speaking logically
- Using simple linking phrases (first, meanwhile, to sum up)

Thinking and reacting in English, not translating!

Daily Practice Routine:

Listening to Real-Life English – 15 minutes

- Listen to real-life spoken English
- Suggested source: @BusinessInsider on Youtube
- Subtitles are fine

Focus on:

- How speakers organise ideas
- How opinions are introduced
- How reasons and examples are added
- How ideas are connected logically
- Write down three useful phrases you hear every day

MONTH 6

Recorded Monologue – 5 minutes

- Record yourself speaking
- Choose one topic from the list in this PDF (below ⬇️)
- Speak continuously for up to 5 minutes

Structure your speaking:

- Introduce the topic
- Give your opinion
- Explain why
- Give one example
- Don't stop or restart. Speak through mistakes.

Reflection & Improvement – 5 minutes

Listen to your recording

Write down:

- One thing you did well
- One difficulty
- One small thing to improve tomorrow

This reflection step is essential for improvement and building confidence.

Core Linking Phrases to organise thoughts (Month 6)

In addition to the linking phrases in Month 5, the following linking phrases will help you structure your daily monologue.

Organising Ideas:

- to begin with
- to follow
- to sum up
- meanwhile

MONTH 6

Explaining/Giving Reasons

- this is because...
- the main reason is...
- consequently...

Adding Examples

- for example...
- for instance...
- a good example of this is...

Summarising

- to sum up...
- overall...
- in short...

These are simple phrases, used for clarity and control.

Speaking Topics (Month 6)

Choose one topic per day for your recorded monologue. Speak for up to 5 minutes. Explain your ideas clearly, give your opinion, explain why, and add one example.

Daily Life & Personal Experience:

- A daily routine that helps you stay organised
- A habit you want to change and why
- Something that recently made your life easier
- A challenge you faced recently and how you handled it
- A decision you had to make in the past year
- A mistake you learnt from
- A personal goal you are working towards
- How you manage stress or pressure
- A change in your lifestyle you are happy about
- Something you would like to improve about your daily life

.

MONTH 6

Work, Study & Professional Life:

- A skill you are currently developing
- A task you do regularly at work or in your studies
- A challenge you face at work or school
- A project you worked on recently
- A decision you had to make at work or in your studies
- What makes someone good at their job
- How you organise your time during a busy day
- Something you find difficult at work or school
- Something you are proud of
- A professional goal you have for the future

Opinions & Ideas:

- What makes communication effective
- Why learning English is important for you
- The advantages of learning online
- The disadvantages of social media
- Whether technology makes life easier or harder
- The importance of lifelong learning
- Why confidence matters when speaking a language
- What makes a good teacher or mentor
- The role of habits in personal success
- Whether mistakes are necessary for learning

Society, Media & Modern Life:

- How technology has changed daily communication
- The impact of social media on attention and focus
- How people learn differently today compared to the past
- The role of English as a global language
- How work life has changed in recent years
- The influence of media on opinions
- The benefits and drawbacks of working remotely
- Why clear communication is important in society
- How people consume information today
- The importance of critical thinking

MONTH 6

Reflection & Personal Growth:

- Something you have improved in your English
- A moment when you felt more confident speaking
- What helps you stay motivated when learning
- A strategy that works well for you
- A difficulty you are still working on
- How your attitude to English has changed
- What “real confidence” means to you
- What you would tell your past self about learning English
- How you plan to continue improving after Month 6!
- What success in English looks like for you

📌 Speaking Tip

- Focus on clarity and logic, not complexity
- Speak continuously - don’t stop to correct yourself

If you finished this six-month plan, well done! That shows real effort.

I hope this workbook has helped. To keep improving your English, regular practice is important. A little every day works best.

If you would like support and clear guidance, you can continue learning with my membership here: https://stan.store/ConfidentEnglishwithKirsty

Take care, Kirsty

TERMS OF USE

Terms of Use
Last updated: 25.11.2025
Please read these Terms of Use ("Terms") carefully before purchasing, downloading, or using the PDF titled "6 Month Study Plan" ("the Product") created by Kirsty ("we", "us", or "our"). By purchasing, accessing, or using the Product, you agree to be bound by these Terms. If you do not agree with these Terms, do not purchase, access, or use the Product.

1. Intellectual Property
All content contained in the Product, including but not limited to text, prompts, formatting, design, and structure, is the intellectual property of Kirsty and is protected by copyright and other applicable intellectual property laws.
You are granted a personal, non-transferable, non-exclusive, revocable license to use the Product solely for your own educational and non-commercial purposes.
You may not:
Reproduce, distribute, sell, or resell the Product, in whole or in part, in any form;
Share, upload, or make the Product available to any third party;
Sublicense, rent, or transfer the Product to others;
Modify or create derivative works based on the Product without prior written consent.
Any unauthorized use of the Product may result in legal action.

2. No Guarantees or Warranties
The Product is provided "as is" for informational and educational purposes only. While we make reasonable efforts to ensure the accuracy and usefulness of the content, we make no guarantees or warranties—express or implied—regarding the effectiveness, results, or outcomes of using this Product.
Your learning progress or results when using the Product depend on factors beyond our control, including your level of English and the time and effort you dedicate to learning English.

3. Limitation of Liability
To the fullest extent permitted by applicable law, we disclaim all liability for any loss, damage, injury, or consequence—direct or indirect—that arises from the use or misuse of the Product or reliance on its content.

4. Prohibited Uses
You may not use the Product:
For any unlawful purpose;
To infringe on any third party's rights;
To develop, market, or distribute a competing product;
To copy, reproduce, share, distribute, sell, resell, upload, or make the Product available to any third party in whole or in part;
To sublicense, rent, or transfer the Product to others;
In any other manner that violates these Terms.

5. Refund Policy
Due to the digital nature of the Product, all sales are final and non-refundable once the Product has been accessed or downloaded, unless otherwise required by law.

6. Modifications
We reserve the right to update or modify these Terms at any time without prior notice. Continued use of the Product after any changes constitutes acceptance of the new Terms.

7. Governing Law
These Terms shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of France, without regard to its conflict of law provisions. Any disputes arising under these Terms shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts located in France.

8. Contact
For any questions regarding these Terms, please contact us at:
question.for.kirsty@gmail.com